```
class HTML_Stuff {
  function start_table( ) {
    echo "<table border='1'>\n";
  }
  function end_table ( ) {
    echo "</table>\n";
  }
}
HTML_Stuff->start_table( );
// print HTML table rows and columns
HTML_Stuff->end_table( );
```

6.3.2 Declaring Properties

In the definition of the Person class, we explicitly declared the $name property. Property declarations are optional and are simply a courtesy to whoever maintains your program. It's good PHP style to declare your properties, but you can add new properties at any time.

Here's a version of the Person class that has an undeclared $name property:

```
class Person {
    function get_name ( )
    {
        return $this->name;    }

    function set_name ($new_name) {
        $this->name = $new_name;
    }
}
```

You can assign default values to properties, but those default values must be simple constants:

```
var $name = 'J Doe';        // works
var $age  = 0;              // works
var $day  = 60*60*24;       // doesn't work
```

Did You Know?

PHP provides a set of special predefined constants and magic methods to your programs. Unlike the constants you would set using define(), the value of the constants depend on where they are used in your code and are used to access read-only information about your code and PHP.